

Secondary Examination, 2015

English

Time: $2\frac{1}{2}$ Hours

Maximum Marks: 80

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS TO THE EXAMINEES:

1. Attempt all questions.
2. The first fifteen minutes is cool –off time.
3. Use the cool –off time to read the questions and plan the answers.

Question 1-6 Read the following passage and answer the question given that follow:

In truth, Jose Montiel was not as rich as he seemed, a few blocks from Balthazar's, he remained indifferent to the news of the cage. His wife was lying in bed with her eyes open, while he took his siesta. Hearing a clamour outside, she opened the door to the living room and found a crowd in front of the house and Balthazar with the cage in the middle of the crowd, dressed in white and freshly shaved.

“What a marvelous thing!” Jose Montiel's wife exclaimed, with a radiant expression, leading Balthazar inside. ‘I've never seen anything like it in my life,’ she said, and added, annoyed by the crowd which piled up at the door.

“Bring it inside before they turn the living room into a grandstand.”

Balthazar was no stranger to Jose Montiel's house. On different occasions, because of his skill and forthright way of dealing, he had been called in to do minor carpentry jobs. But he never felt at ease among the rich.

Questions:

1. ‘What a marvelous thing!’ What appeared marvellous to Jose Montiel's wife? (1)
2. How did Jose Montiel react to Balthazar's achievement? (1)
3. In what way, according to Jose Montiel's wife, will the living room be made a ‘grandstand’? (1)
4. Pick out the word from the passage that means, ‘sleep taken in the early afternoon’. (1)
5. What are two qualities of Balthazar mentioned in the passage above? (2)
6. Pick out the sentence from the passage that shows Balthazar's attitude towards people who have lot of money. (1)

Solution:

1. The cage
2. He remained indifferent.
3. The crowd of people piled up at the door will rush into the living room and make it a grand stand.
4. Siesta
5. Skill and forthright way of dealing
6. He never felt at ease among the rich.

Question 7-10 Read the lines from 'Night of the Scorpion' and answer the question given that follow:

I remember the night my mother
was stung by a scorpion. Ten hours
of steady rain had driven him
to crawl beneath a sack of rice.

Parting with his poison – flash
Of diabolic tail in the dark room –
He risked the rain again.

The peasants came like swarms of flies
and buzzed the name of God a hundred times
to paralyse the Evil One.

Questions:

7. What made the scorpion hide under the sack of rice (1)
8. Pick out the visual image that is used in the above lines to show the devilish nature of the scorpion. (1)
9. Which expression is used to convey the idea that the scorpion stung the mother? (1)
10. Pick out an instance of simile used in the lines above? (1)

Solution:

7. Ten hours of steady rain
8. Flash of diabolic tail in the dark room
9. Parting with his poison
10. The peasants came like swarms of flies.

Question 11-14 Read the lines from 'In the Country' and answer the question given that follow:

But it's a wretched life to face

Hunger in almost every place;

Cursed with a hand that's empty, when

The heart is full to help all men.

Can I admire the statue great,

When living men strave at its feet?

Can I admire the park's green tree,

A roof for homeless misery?

11. The speaker says that he can't help the people in misery. Why? (1)
12. What prevents the poet from 'admiring the statue great'? (1)
13. How does the poet describe the park's green tree? (1)
14. Identify the rhyme scheme follows in the poem. (1)

Solutions:

11. His hands are empty.
12. Living men starve at its feet.
13. A roof for homeless misery
14. aabb

Question 15-19 Read the following passage and answer the question given that follow:

Jagadananda Roy was one of the teachers at the Santiniketan School. He was known for his strictness and fiery temper. Once, Rabindranath Tagore had decided to stage a play at Santiniketan. A young boy was chosen for a particular role in the play. Tagore sent for the boy to be fetched from his class, Jagadananda Roy was then taking the boy's mathematics class. Visibly annoyed by the student's performance he sent back the messenger with the terse reply, "Tell Gurudev that during my class boys don't go dancing and performing." Tagore's colleagues were visibly embarrassed at Jagadananda's reply but Tagore was unmoved. Smiling he replied, "The teacher is angry. The only way he's going to release the boy now is to ask him to be part of the

play". That year Jagadananda performed in the play himself. He never disagreed to release one of his students for a rehearsal later!

Questions:

15. What was the subject taught by Jagadananda Roy at the Santiniketan School? (1)
16. On what occasion did Jagadananda Roy refuse to obey Tagore's instruction? (1)
17. How did Tagore solve the issue of fetching the boy from Jagadananda Roy's class? (1)
18. Why were the teachers of Santiniketan embarrassed? (1)
19. Pick out the word from the passage that means, 'someone that you work with'. (1)

Solutions:

15. Mathematics
16. Jagadananda Roy refused to obey Tagore's instruction when he sent for a boy to be fetched from his class.
17. Tagore solved the issue by asking Mr. Roy to be a part of the play.
18. Jagadananda's reply that the boys didn't go dancing and performing during his class embarrassed the teachers of Santiniketan.
19. Colleague

20. Answer any one of the following in about 120 words: (7)

(A) Imagine that you are narrating the story 'Blue Bouquet' to one of your friends. You narrate the horrifying experience of meeting a stranger who tried to gouge your eyes. What would you **narrate**?

You may begin like: I was staying in a hotel.

(Hints: neglects the warning of the hotel keeper- goes out into the dark – enjoys the beauty of night – stranger follows – threatens – demands eyes – tries to gouge them – finds the eyes not blue – disappears – returns to the hotel)

OR

The beggar in the play 'The Beggar and the King' is not a mere beggar. He is the representative of the people who are forced to live in misery under autocratic rulers. Prepare a **write up** substantiating this view.

(Hints: the beggar begs even after his tongue is cut – the words of the servant – the way the beggar deals with the king – the king's fear – the beggar begs again – the king orders to close the window)

Solution 20:

Format for Narrative:

- Proper beginning and end.
- Time and place of action.
- Organisation of ideas.
- Creativity and imagination

OR

Format for Write-up

- A suitable Title
- Begins with sticking idea
- Ideas are presented using Specific and clear language.
- Ideas are organized well.
- Used variety of sentences
- Appropriate conclusion.

21. Samuel in the story 'Father's Help' is portrayed as a teacher who has great consideration for his students. But Swami gives a different picture of Samuel. Prepare a **character sketch** of Samuel comparing Swami's portrayal of Samuel and the real Samuel. (5)

Solution 21:

The format to write character sketch is:

- Beginning
 - Quotation
 - Anecdote
- Remainder of First paragraph
 - Most important traits
- Following paragraphs- Supporting details!
 - What does your character look like?
 - What does the character do?
 - How does your character think?
 - How does your character speak?
- Conclusion- Your opinion
 - How do you feel about your character?

22. You are asked to speak in your school assembly on the topic, 'Disappearing public spaces'. Prepare a **speech** highlighting the role of tea – shops in Kerala society in maintaining communal harmony and providing a space for free interaction among different sections of people. (5)

Solution 22:

There are 3 parts of a Simple Speech:

1. Introduction – Tell the audience what you are going to tell them.
2. Body – Deliver the speech you promised.
3. Ending – Tell them what you told them.

23. The film Club of your school has decided to organize a Children's Film Festival. The Festival is to be inaugurated by Sri M.T. Vasudevan Nair. Draft a **notice** for the inaugural ceremony of the festival. (5)

Solution 23:

Format to write notice:

- Uses appropriate format and layout of a notice
- Uses proper salutation.
- Mentions the date, time and venue of the programme
- Uses clear and brief language
- Includes the details of the programme
- Specifies the agency /Authority which issues the notice

24. Imagine that you make a visit to Balthazar's home to buy the cage. Write the **likely conversation** between Balthazar and you. (5)

Solution 24:

Points to avoid in writing conversation:

1. Avoid fillers
2. Cut Unnecessary Dialogue Tags
3. Avoid fancy Dialogue tags
4. Change the Placement of Dialogue Tags
5. Include Disagreement or Conflicts.
6. Involve Character's Desires, Goals, and Fears
7. Include Subtle Gestures and Subtext
8. Add context for atmosphere and Tone

Format of Conversation:

1. Using Right Punctuation
2. Insert Quotation Marks
3. Use Exclamation and Question Marks
4. Use Ellipses and Dashes Correctly
5. Break a long Dialogue into Short paragraphs.

25. Prepare a **profile** of Sri. K. Satchidanandan, poet and critic writing in Malayalam and English, using the details given below: (5)

Birth: 28 may 1946, Puloor, Kodungallur, Kerala

Education: Maharajas College Ernakulam
PhD – Calicut University

Career: Professor – Christ College, Irinjalakuda
Editor – Indian Literature
Secretary- Kendra Sahitya Akademi

Notable works: Anchu Sooryan (1971), Venal Mazha (1982), Ivanekoodi (1987), Kavibudhban (1992), Mukhamukham (2006)

Awards: Kerala Sahitya Akademi Award (1989), Kendra Sahitya Akademi Award (2012)

Solution 25:

Format to write Profile:

- Give a title
- Effective introduction and ending.
- Well Organised Details.
- Use of Appropriate descriptive vocabulary.
- Hints developed using supporting details.
- Use of proper linkers for connecting the ideas
- Use of appropriate language.

26. Prepare a summary of the film, ‘Sunshine through the Rain’ by sequencing and developing the hints given below: (5)

- () A fox comes and hands over a dagger to the mother
- () Mother prevents the boy from going out
- () Boy watches foxes ‘wedding
- () The sun shines when it rains
- () The boy walks out of home and reaches the valley of rainbows
- () The boy goes out to the forest and hides behind a tree

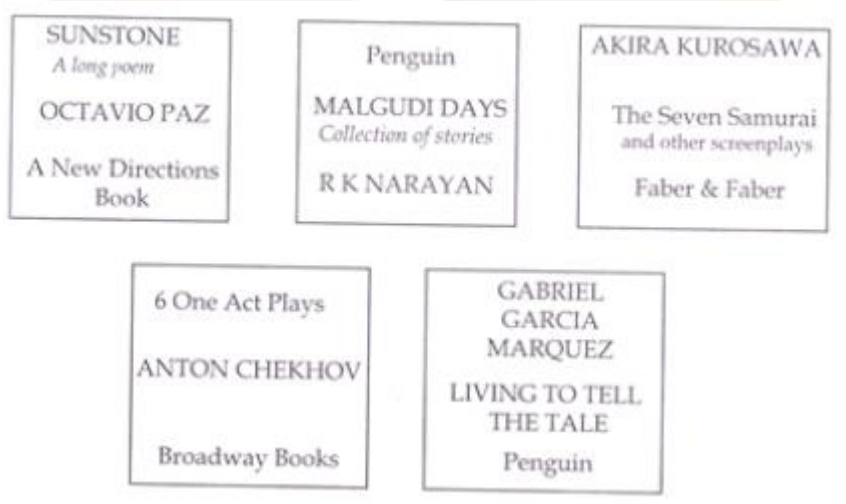
() A boy stands in the veranda and watches the rain

() Mother shuts the door

Solution 26:

- (a) The sun shines when it rains.
- (b) A boy stands in the veranda and watches the rain.
- (c) Mother prevents the boy from going out.
- (d) The boy goes out to the forest and hides behind a tree.
- (e) Boy watches foxes' wedding.
- (f) A fox comes and hands over a dagger to the mother.
- (g) Mother shuts the door.
- (h) The boy walks out of home and reaches the valley of rainbows.

Questions 27- 31: Look at the front covers of the following books and answer the questions that follows:



- 27. If you wish to buy a book written by an Indian author which book will you select? (1)
- 28. Which publisher has presented two titles for you to select? (1)
- 29. Name the only poet out of the above author. (1)
- 30. Who authored '6 One Act Plays'? (1)
- 31. Which book has a world famous film as its title? (1)

Solutions:

- 27. Malgudi Days
- 28. Penguin
- 29. Octavio Paz
- 30. Anton Chekhov

31. The Seven Samurai and other screenplays

32. The banker and the young lawyer are talking about capital punishment. Read the dialogue between them and complete it suitably. (5)

Banker: You don't mind imprisonment for life, _____ (a) _____ ?

Lawyer: No, if I can earn a huge amount like this.

Banker: _____ (b) _____ ?

Lawyer: Yes, I've thought about it very well.

Banker: If you were in jail, _____ (c) _____

Lawyer: I stake my freedom for two millions!

Banker: _____ (d) _____

Lawyer: I'm trying to prove imprisonment for life is better than death penalty.

Banker: The more you argue _____ (e) _____

Solution 32:

- (a) do you?
- (b) Haven't you thought about it very well?
- (c) you wouldn't be free
- (d) What are you trying to prove?
- (e) the more you endure

33. The following paragraph is from the letter written by Swami to his friend. There are a few errors in it. They are underlined. Edit them. (4)

I have lied (a) to my father yesterday. I had to face all sorts of problems because of that. When I reached the school Samuel sir took (b) the class. He asked me why was I (c) late. Again, I had to lie and told him that I has a headache. I was surprising (d) when he allowed me to enter the class.

Solution 33.

- (a) Lied
- (b) was taking
- (c) why I was
- (d) surprised

34. Look at the following word pyramid. (3)

Girl

The girl
The girl with pearl earrings
The girl with pearl earrings who sells bangles

Now, construct a similar pyramid with Pen.

Solution 34.

Pen
The pen
The pen in black ink
The pen in black ink which writes well

35. Choose the appropriate phrasal verbs from the ones given and complete the passage given below: (4)

Mother **rejected** (a) the children's plea for going out and play. Finally they were allowed to play within the compound. They **started** (b) to play hide and seek. Ravi hid in a shed and could not **understand** (c) what was happening outside. When he came out, the other children had **abandoned** (d) hide and seek and had started another game.

Give up	Set out	Turn on	Put on	Make up	Make out
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Solution 35:

- a) turned down
- b) set out
- c) make out
- d) given up

36. Read the piece of conversation and answer the questions that follow:

Holmes: Do you think our visitor is a doctor?

Watson: There is a possibility to be so.

- (a) What did Holmes ask Watson? (1)
- (b) What was Watson's reply? (1)

Solution 36:

- (a) Holmes asked Watson whether he thought their visitor was a doctor.

(b) Watson replied that there was a possibility to be so.

